Name: _____ Date: _____

SALVE & VALE!

Salve!

Vale!

How Romans said hello and goodbye

Just Listen Learning • Latin for Families • Lesson 1

1. Flashcards

Cut along the dashed lines. Fold each card on the middle line: Latin on the front, meaning on the back.

salve	fold	**Hello!** *to one person • "Be well!"*
salvete	fold	**Hello, everyone!** *to two or more people*
vale	fold	**Goodbye!** *to one person • "Stay strong! Stay well!"*
valete	fold	**Goodbye, everyone!** *to two or more people*

2. Say It Two Ways

Both are real Latin. Circle your family's way!

	Classical V sounds like W	Church V sounds like V
salve	**SAHL-way**	**SAHL-veh**
salvete	**sal-WAY-teh**	**sal-VEH-teh**
vale	**WAH-lay**	**VAH-leh**
valete	**wah-LAY-teh**	**vah-LEH-teh**

Tip: always say the final E out loud!

3. Word Family Match

Match each English cousin to its meaning.

salute	● brave and strong
safe	● gives the farewell speech
valiant	● a greeting
value	● what something is worth
valedictorian	● out of danger, unharmed

4. Your Turn

Write salve, salvete, vale, or valete in each blank. (Hint: one person or more than one?)

1. You walk into the kitchen and see Mom.
   Latin: _____
2. Your friend heads home after playing.
   Latin: _____
3. Grandma and Grandpa come to visit.
   Latin: _____
4. Your whole family leaves the dinner table.
   Latin: _____
5. You say hi to one friend at the park.
   Latin: _____
6. You wave to everyone at the end of a video call.
   Latin: _____

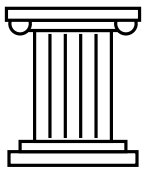
5. Fun Facts

Roman letters: Romans often ended a letter with one word: Vale! Many letters began with S.V.B.E.E.V., short for a Latin sentence meaning "If you are well, that's good. I am well."

Look-alike: The English word vale means a valley. It comes from a different Latin word, so it is not a cousin.

☆ **Dinner challenge: greet everyone with Salvete! and leave with Valete!** ☆

Answer Key: Salve & Vale



Just Listen Learning • Latin for Families, Lesson 1 • For parents and teachers

1. Flashcards

salve = Hello! (to one person; "Be well!")
salvete = Hello, everyone! (to two or more people)
vale = Goodbye! (to one person; "Stay strong! Stay well!")
valete = Goodbye, everyone! (to two or more people)

2. Say It Two Ways

salve: classical SAHL-way, church SAHL-veh
salvete: classical sal-WAY-teh, church sal-VEH-teh
vale: classical WAH-lay, church VAH-leh
valete: classical wah-LAY-teh, church vah-LEH-teh
Either circle is correct. Classical Latin is how people spoke in ancient Rome; church Latin is how Latin is spoken in churches today.

3. Word Family Match

salute = a greeting
safe = out of danger, unharmed
valiant = brave and strong
value = what something is worth
valedictorian = often the top student, who gives the farewell speech at graduation

4. Your Turn

1. salve (You walk into the kitchen and see Mom.)
2. vale (Your friend heads home after playing.)
3. salvete (Grandma and Grandpa come to visit.)
4. valete (Your whole family leaves the dinner table.)
5. salve (You say hi to one friend at the park.)
6. valete (You wave to everyone at the end of a video call.)

5. Remember

Use salve and vale for one person. Add -te (salvete, valete) for two or more people.
Salve comes from a Latin verb meaning "to be well." Vale comes from a verb meaning "to be strong" or "to be well."

All drawings are original line art. Facts are checked against Latin dictionaries (Lewis & Short, Georges, Gaffiot) and English dictionaries (Merriam-Webster, American Heritage, Dictionary.com). Free to print for your family or classroom.